The 5 fields every CloudTrail log entry contains

Field	What it tells you
`eventTime`	When the API call was made (UTC)
`eventName`	Which API action was called e.g. `StopLogging`, `AssumeRole`
`userIdentity`	Who made the call — IAM user, role, root, or AWS service
`sourceIPAddress`	Where the call came from — IP address or AWS service name
`requestParameters`	What arguments were passed — e.g. which bucket, which trail

Write: How would you use CloudTrail to investigate a security incident?

- **Time window** — narrow to when the anomaly was first detected
- **eventName** — look for destructive or unusual actions: `DeleteTrail`, `CreateUser`, `AttachUserPolicy`, `GetSecretValue`
- **userIdentity** — identify which principal acted. If it's an unfamiliar role or root, that's a red flag
- **sourceIPAddress** — check if the IP is internal, a known AWS service, or an unexpected foreign IP
- **requestParameters** — see exactly what resource was targeted

Write a 3-step incident response process using CloudTrail as evidence.

- **Step 1 — Detect & scope** Query CloudTrail (via Athena or CloudWatch Logs Insights) for anomalous `eventName` values in the affected account and time window. Identify the compromised `userIdentity` and every action they took.
- **Step 2 — Contain** Revoke the compromised principal's credentials immediately (disable IAM keys, invalidate the session token). Use CloudTrail's `requestParameters` to identify every resource touched — S3 buckets read, secrets accessed, roles assumed — and lock those down.
- **Step 3 — Recover & report** Restore affected resources from clean backups. Export the full CloudTrail event history as your evidence record for the CBN regulatory report, internal post-mortem, and any legal proceedings. Confirm CloudTrail itself was not tampered with

AWS cheat sheet

CloudTrail — audit, investigate, respond

5 FIELDS IN EVERY LOG ENTRY

`eventTime`
When the call was made (UTC)

`eventName`
Which API action was called

`userIdentity`
Who made the call — IAM user, role, root

`sourceIPAddress`
Where the call came from

`requestParameters`
Arguments passed — bucket, trail, etc.

INVESTIGATING A SECURITY INCIDENT — WHAT TO FILTER FOR

`DeleteTrail / StopLogging`
Attacker covering tracks

`CreateUser / AttachUserPolicy`
Privilege escalation attempt

`GetSecretValue`
Credential or key exfiltration

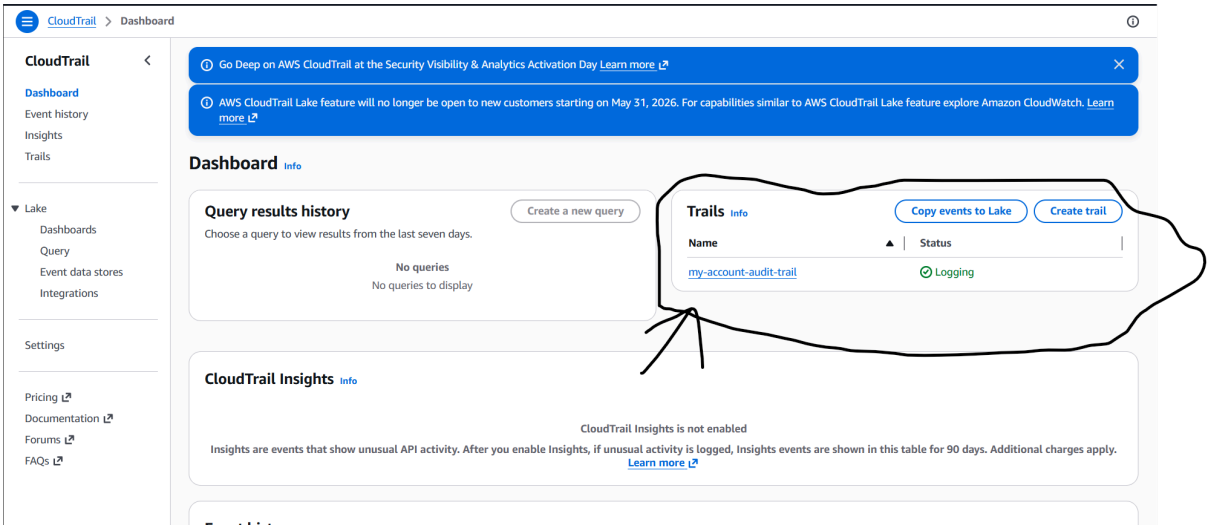
`AssumeRole`
Lateral movement across accounts

`sourceIPAddress`
Unexpected foreign IP = red flag

`userIdentity = root`
Should almost never appear

3-STEP INCIDENT RESPONSE USING CLOUDTRAIL

1. **Detect & scope**
   Query CloudTrail via Athena or CloudWatch Logs Insights. Filter by time window + suspicious `eventName`. Identify the compromised `userIdentity` and every action they took.
2. **Contain**
   Revoke IAM keys and invalidate session tokens immediately. Use `requestParameters` to list every resource touched — lock them down. Isolate affected accounts if needed.
3. **Recover & report**
   Restore from clean backups. Export the full CloudTrail event history as your evidence record for CBN compliance, post-mortem, and any legal proceedings.


```
        "eventTime": "2026-04-30T18:08:27Z",
        "eventSource": "iam.amazonaws.com",
        "eventName": "DeleteUser",
        "awsRegion": "us-east-1",
```

```
"eventTime": "2026-04-30T17:38:03Z",
"eventSource": "iam.amazonaws.com",
"eventName": "CreateUser",
"awsRegion": "us-east-1",
```